DELHI PUBLIC SCHOOL JANKIPURAM

SET–II

HALF YEARLY EXAMINATION: (2024-25)

SUBJECT: ENGLISH LANGUAGE AND LITERATURE (184)

GRADE: IX

Time – 3 hrs. M.M. 80

Name- _____ Roll No- _____ Date- _____

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General Instructions:

Read the following instructions carefully and follow them:

1. This Question Paper contains the following sections: READING, WRITING & GRAMMAR and LITERATURE.
2. Attempt questions based on specific instructions for each part.

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SECTION A (READING COMPREHENSION)

I. Read the following passage and answer the questions carefully. **(10)**

Cricket in South Asia is a carnivalesque, festive game. It carries not merely the baggage of competition and achievement but is also a participatory cultural event that evokes images of religious festivals, convivial social gatherings, picnics and theatre. It is now gradually becoming a substitute for war, a means of redeeming self-esteem and expressing xenophobia, a depot of weird conspiracy theories. No country now loses a game because the other side is better, a country loses only because its cricketers and cricket administrators are patriotic, corrupt, greedy or self-centred.

Unfortunately for ultra-nationalists and fortunately for the rest, cricket is one game in which the best training, organisation and preparation do not yield corresponding results. It is a subversive game that rebels against the productivity principle on which is built, the world of globalised capitalism. Luck plays a major role in the final outcome of a match or series. In this respect, cricket is unlike football, tennis or chess. The grandeur of cricket and the clichéd references to its glorious uncertainties come from a cultivated ignorance of this inner contradiction in the game. Cricketers and their fans to say nothing of the experts have to learn to live with the unpredictability without getting overly judgemental or paranoiac. All games have some built-in uncertainties, only cricket has turned the gracious acceptance of this into a measure of character.

Let us not forget that in cricket the 22 players involved are never on the field at the same time. Consequently, one team may play in full sunshine, while the other have to play under an overcast sky when the ball begins to swing. One team may bat on a green top, the other on a veering pitch. You can never truly equalise the outer conditions for the two teams. So a cricketer not merely plays against the opposition, but also against his own fate. That is one reason why it is typically Indian or, if you prefer, South Asian game.

This is a cultural region that recognises the role of destiny in human affairs. All cricketers are superstitious because of the nature of their job. Only South Asians are not embarrassed about it and have unashamedly built ritualised ways of dealing with destiny as a normal part of a cricketer's life. If you want a game where the investment of money, hard training and ruthless professionalism will pay predictable results, and the results will be a pure reflection of skill and talent, you should choose another game.

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On the basis of your understanding of the passage, answer the following questions:

1. The meaning of the first sentence is (1)
   a. that during cricket matches, carnivals are organised
   b. that cricket is seasonal like festivals
   c. that a cricket match is a cultural event like a festival or a carnival
   d. that cricket is not a game but a carnival festival.
2. How is cricket becoming a substitute for war? (1)
   a. Countries staked their image and self-esteem on the outcome of the game.
   b. Political interests have invaded the game.
   c. Cricket teams received international funding.
   d. The spectators are filled with patriotic sentiments.
3. Cricket rebels against the productivity principle means that: (1)
   a. cricket does not produce results.
   b. cricket is played by rebels.
   c. the principles of cricket are rebellious and unproductive.
   d. training and preparation do not necessarily bring success.
4. Baggage in the above passage means: (1)
   a. Elements
   b. Cricket bats and balls etc.
   c. Luggage
   d. Handbags
5. According to the passage, can we equalise the outer conditions for the two teams? (1)
   a. Yes
   b. Sometimes
   c. Never
   d. Cannot be determined
6. 'Corresponding' in the above passage means: (1)
   a. writing
   b. matching
   c. relating to correspondence
   d. expected
7. Cricket has turned the gracious acceptance of this into a measure of character? **True/ False** (1)
8. Cricket is one game which has the..... Complete the statement. (1)
9. How can it be said that cricketers are superstitious? (2)

II. Read the following case based passage and answer the questions given. (10)

Research from the Publishers Association has shown that film based on books take 44% more at the box office revenue in the UK and 53% more worldwide than original screenplays. The report explores what impact a book has when adapted from film and TV.

The report reads: "Published material is the basis of 52% of top UK films in the last 10 years, and accounts for an even higher share of revenue from these leading performers, at 61% of UK box office gross and 65% of worldwide gross." The Hollywood adaptation of 'My Cousin Rachel' has shown to have a significant impact on the sales of the Daphne Du Maurier thriller. The sales of the book in 2017 alone accounted for 23% of all sales since 1992.

The research suggests that adapted films tend to perform better, because films can leverage the popularity of well-known books through an existing audience. Films adapted from books

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also tend to have a richer more fully developed story to draw on. In terms of TV adaptation, it was revealed that ¼ of dramas were based on literary sources and attracted a 56% larger share of the audience than those based on original scripts. 14 of the 35 high end series produced in the UK in the period between January and September 2017 were based on books, compared to seven based on true stories or historical events and five based on pre-existing films or TV stories.

In the case of the 2016 BBC broadcast of the night manager, research revealed that while the novel was in circulation for over 25 years, 82% of the copies it sold were in 2016 and 2017. Sales of the paperback edition remained strong in 2017 even after the series went off the air.

In conclusion, the report states that there is a strong two way relationship between publishing and the wider creative economy, there in a successful adaptation often has spill over effects and gives a substantial boost to the sales of the original book.

On the basis of your understanding of the passage answer the following questions:

1. The purpose of the research by Publishers Association was to study ..... (1)
   a. variety in films and TV shows.
   b. impact of films on books.
   c. choice of books for film making.
   d. connect between books and films.
2. Select the option that is true for the two statements given below.
   (1) The revenues generated at the box office have increased.
   (2) Majority of the top films in the UK are based on published material. (1)
   a. (1) is the result of (2)
   b. (1) is the reason for (2)
   c. (1) is independent of (2)
   d. (1) contradicts (2)
3. Select the option that gives the correct meaning of the following statement. "The sales of the book in 2017 alone accounted for 23% of all the sales since 1992." (1)
   a. There were 23% higher sales in 2017 than previous years.
   b. A major chunk of sales happened in 2017.
   c. The sales were limited to 23% in 2017.
   d. There were very few books sold in the previous years.
4. Why do films based on books have greater success? (2)
5. Find a word from the passage which is the synonym of influence. adaptation (1)
6. Find a word from the passage which is the antonym of worthless. (1)
7. On what from the following were the maximum TV serials in UK in the year 2017 based? (1)
   a. Books
   b. historical stories
   c. original true stories
   d. previous films
8. The passage lists an example proving that TV dramas based on literary works have..... (1)
   a. increased the immediate sales of the book.
   b. increase the sales of the book during the first screening.
   c. had no immediate impact on the sales of the book.
   d. had very little impact on the sales of the book.

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9. There is a two-way relationship between books and the screen. This is so because both..... (1)

a. revolve around the same stories.
b. cater to an audience with the same taste.
c. gain from each other's popularity.
d. belong to the creative field.

SECTION B (CREATIVE WRITING AND GRAMMAR)

III. You are Pranjal/ Anjali studying in class IX. You have been preparing for your Half Yearly Examinations very diligently for the past one month. When you were to appear for the exam, you suddenly went blank and lost all confidence to answer the paper. Make a **diary entry** in 100 – 120 words about your feelings and how you managed to answer the questions well. (5)

OR

You are recovering from the pain of losing your pet dog Freedo who died due to an illness. You are doubtful whether to bring a new pet or never have another one as a replacement for Freedo. Write a heartfelt **diary entry** in about 100 – 120 words expressing your feelings and emotions about it.

IV. Write an interesting **story** in about 100 -120 words based on the given guided outline: Smitha waiting at a railway station- bought a packet of biscuits- a poor beggar asked for food- Smitha turned to give some biscuits- beggar snatches the bag- runs away- Smitha felt be fooled- goes to the platform- sees the same beggar sharing the biscuits with stray dogs- moral (5)

OR

Spin an interesting **story** in about 100- 120 words based on the following beginning clue- Once a poor farmer lived with his wife and two kids in an old hut. One night....

V. Attempt any TEN. **(1 X 10= 10)**

1. Chose the correct option and fill in the blank.
   It has been _____ heavily since morning.
   a. rained b. raining c. rains d. rain
2. I need _____ oranges to make marmalade.
   a. much b. this c. some d. any
3. Identify the error and supply its correction.
   I cannot afford to pay that more of it.
   Incorrect Correct
   move much
4. Fill in the blank with a suitable option.
   No sooner did he go in _____ he came out.
   a. than b. then c. and d. when
5. Identify the error and supply its correction.
   '100 days' are my favourite movie.
   Incorrect Correct
   are is
6. Identify the error and supply its correction.
   I have to usually reached my office by 9 a.m.
   Incorrect Correct
   reached reach

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7. There were not more than _____ people present.
   a. little b. a few c. less d. the few
8. A pair of branded glasses _____ quite expensive these days.
   a. was b. are c. is d. has
9. I _____ speak French fluently when we lived in France ten years ago.
   a. could b. can c. will d. had better
10. Students _____ leave the classroom before the bell rings.
   a. must b. can c. should d. shouldn't
11. Identify the error and supply its correction.
   Each of the mangoes were fresh.
   Incorrect Correct
   were are

SECTION C (LITERATURE)

VI. Reference to context. (Attempt any ONE) (5)

A. **The poor child struggled to thrust a way between their feet but, knocked to and fro by their brutal movement, he might have been trampled underfoot, had he not shrieked at the highest pitch of his voice.**

1. What was the child doing? (2)
2. How did the boy get stuck in the huge crowd? (1)
   a. He went to visit the fair all by himself and got lost.
   b. He got separated from his parents.
   c. He silently left his parents to see the colourful balloons and got lost.
   d. A stranger took him away from his parents and abandoned him in the crowd.
3. Why did the child shriek? (1)
   a. He wanted to be heard and escape or avoid the crowd from getting hurt.
   b. He was utterly scared about getting lost.
   c. He wanted to grab everyone's attention.
   d. Both (a) and (b).
4. Find a word from the passage which is an antonym of 'gentle'. (1)

OR

B. **By the time she was 11 her marks had deteriorated and her head mistress urged her parents to take her to a specialist. It was then discovered that her hearing was severely impaired as a result of gradual nerve damage. They were advised that she should be fitted with hearing aids and sent to a school for the deaf.**

1. When was Evelyn's deafness first diagnosed? (1)
   a. When she was in her piano class
   b. When she was eight years old
   c. When she was 11 years old
   d. When she went to the Royal Academy of music
2. What was the specialist's diagnosis and what did he advise Evelyn? (2)
3. Find a word from the given extract which means the same as 'to go from bad to worse'? (1)
4. The author of the given extract is - (1)
   a. Douglas James
   b. Vikram Seth
   c. Deborah Cowley
   d. James Kirkup

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VII. Reference to context. (Attempt Any ONE) (5)

A. *And both that morning equally lay*
In leaves no step had trodden black.
Oh, I kept the first for another day!
Yet knowing how way leads onto way,
I doubted if I should ever come back.

1. Why did the roads lay equally that morning? (2)
2. What doubt does the poet have? (1)
   a. If he had chosen the right path.
   b. If he would be able to complete his journey.
   c. If he would be able to return on the same path and walk on the road he left for another day.
   d. If he would be surrounded by dangers on the road.
3. Whom does 'both' refer to? (1)
   a. The poet and his friend.
   b. The two roads.
   c. The poet and his enemy.
   d. The trees.
4. Find a word from the extract which means the same as 'walked'. (1)

OR

B. *Let's join the doors firmly.*
Practise to firm the body.
Make the heart steadfast.
Do this, and the wind will be friends with us.
The wind blows out weak fires.
He makes strong fires roar and flourish.
His friendship is good.
We praise him every day.

1. Why does the poet ask us to make doors and houses strong? (1)
   a. So that they are durable
   b. So that there can be no theft.
   c. So that the violent wind cannot destroy them.
   d. So that the people can live peacefully.
2. How can we befriend the wind? (2)
3. How does the wind treat strong fires? (1)
   a. It makes them strong
   b. It makes them flourish
   c. It becomes enemy with fire.
   d. It blows out fire.
4. Which poetic device has been used in the line "He makes strong fires roar and flourish"? (1)
   a. Alliteration
   b. Anaphora
   c. Hyperbole
   d. Metaphor

VIII. **Answer the following in 40- 50 words. Any FOUR** **(4 X 3 = 12)**

1. How does Tommy find the telebooks of his own time to be better?
2. How did Einstein react to the bombing of the Japanese cities Hiroshima and Nagasaki by America?

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3. How does the wind make fun of the weaklings?
4. When did the doctor feel like a foolish, weak person? Why?
5. Kezia's efforts to please her father resulted in displeasing him very much. How did this happen?

IX. **Answer the following in 40- 50 words. Any <u>TWO</u>** **(2 X 3 = 6)**

1. How many pets did the author's grandfather have? Where were they kept?
2. What did the tusker do before Iswaran controlled it?
3. What happened when the little child entered the grove? How did he enjoy there?

X. **Answer any <u>ONE</u> of the following questions in 100 -120 words.** **(6)**

1. What are the recurring themes of Bismillah Khan's music and how did they originate?

OR

2. Why does the poet doubt he should ever come back?

XI. **Answer any <u>ONE</u> of the following questions in 100 -120 words.** **(6)**

1. What were the things that the boy wanted to possess when he was with his parents?

OR

2. What human values do you see in Grandmother after reading this story?

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